

money than others is simply to work harder.

Resolve to work 12 hours per day. One well-focused, determined person will earn more money working 12 hours per day than two will make working 8 hours each. As we suggested earlier, that's why a two-income family, over time, may actually earn less than a one-income family. Do we know that for a fact? No, it's just an observation and a hunch. A person who works 8 hours per day should earn about as much as everyone else who works 8 hours per day. The way to earn more, *ceteris paribus*, is to work more. But you have to understand that it is not just the number of hours that counts. You cannot build a fortune on time alone. You have to do something in which your time compounds your earnings.

Starting out, the person who works 4 hours more per day should earn 50 percent more than his 8-hour-per-day colleague. One person's time is about as valuable as another. Neither has any real experience or skill that can be leveraged into great earnings.

So, starting out, a young couple, each working 8 hours per day, will earn more than the single worker who puts in 12 hours per day—25 percent more, in fact.

But earnings are a consequence of accumulated effort *over time*. So the guy who puts in 4 more hours per day accumulates much more experience and knowledge than either of the couple who each work eight hours. After five years, he's been on the job 5,000 hours longer than his colleague. That's the equivalent of 2.5 years more.

This gap between the 8-hour worker and the 12-hour worker continues to widen, year after year, so that after 10 years, the 12-hour worker is still working 50 percent more per day, but he also has 10,000 more hours on the job. A person with so much more experience should be much more valuable. His skills should have not merely added up but compounded. He is the rare person with substantially more experience and skill than his colleagues. At this point, he will probably not earn just 50 percent more than his coworkers, but more like 200 percent or 400 percent more.

Of course, this is not true for hourly work. But it is true in most businesses or professions where experience counts. The world is a competitive place. The winning players do not just win marginally—they